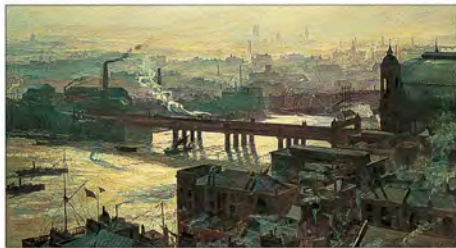




# RICHES OF INDUSTRY

One of the biggest changes in the history of the world, the Industrial Revolution, started in Britain in the late 18th century. As the “Workshop of the World,” Britain was the first home of new machines, new types of materials, and new ways of making power. This was the age of coal and iron, of gas and electricity, of railroads and factories.

Within 50 years this series of mighty inventions had dramatically changed the way in which people lived. Railroads and steamships made it possible to travel quickly from place to place. Instead of living in the country, many more people lived in towns and cities. There they worked in factories where machines made things in vast numbers, quickly and cheaply.



## Grim conditions

The big industrial cities were very smoky, and many people were crammed together in badly built houses.



*Modern photography was invented by the British scientist William Fox Talbot during the 1830s. It soon became popular for people to have their photograph taken.*



*The railroads and cheaper paper provided many more readers with news of events from all over the world.*